

PSY502 - Lesson 33

Alfred Adler and Individual Psychology

1. Who Was Alfred Adler

Alfred Adler was an Austrian doctor and psychologist who lived from 1870 to 1937. He first studied medicine, then became interested in mental health and human behavior. He worked with Sigmund Freud for some time but later disagreed with him and started his own school of thought called **Individual Psychology**.

Key terms

- *Psychiatrist* – A medical doctor who treats mental and emotional disorders.
- *Psychoanalysis* – A method of understanding the mind by studying unconscious thoughts and early childhood experiences.

Explanation (friendly voice)

Adler started as a medical doctor. He treated eyes first, then general illnesses, and later mental problems. He joined Freud's group but did not fully agree with Freud's focus on sex and unconscious conflict. Adler believed people are more motivated by **goals, meaning, and growth**, not just hidden desires.

Example

Freud said: "Your behavior comes from unconscious sexual conflicts."

Adler said: "Your behavior comes from your effort to improve yourself and feel important."

Tip

Remember Adler as the psychologist of **purpose and growth**, not just problems.

2. What Is Individual Psychology?

Answer

Individual Psychology is Adler's theory that we must understand a person as a **whole**, not in pieces. The word *individual* literally means "not divided." Adler believed personality is best understood by looking at a person's **lifestyle**.

Key terms

- *Individual* – Whole, complete, not broken into parts.
- *Lifestyle* – The unique way a person lives, thinks, feels, and solves problems.

Explanation

Adler did not like breaking people into parts like id, ego, superego. He said you must see the **entire person**. Your lifestyle includes how you handle stress, relationships, school, work, and goals.

Example

Two students fail an exam:

- One says, "I will work harder next time."
- The other says, "I am useless."

Their **lifestyles** are different.

Tip

Lifestyle = your personal "pattern" of living.

3. The Main Motivation: Striving for Perfection

Answer

Adler said all humans are motivated by one basic force called **striving for perfection**. It means trying to become better, stronger, and more complete.

Key terms

- *Striving* – Trying hard to achieve something.
- *Perfection* – Not perfect like a robot, but reaching your full potential.
- *Self-actualization* – Becoming the best version of yourself.

Explanation

We all want to grow. We want to feel capable, successful, and meaningful. This drive pushes us to study, work, improve skills, and set goals.

Example

A shy student joins debates to gain confidence.

That is striving for perfection.

Tip

Adler believed people are **future-oriented**, not just stuck in the past.

4. Organic Inferiority

Answer

Organic inferiority means having some physical or biological weakness in the body.

Key terms

- *Organic* – Related to the body or organs.
- *Inferiority* – Feeling less capable or weaker than others.

Explanation

Adler noticed that people often have weak parts in their body (like poor eyesight, weak lungs, short height). These weaknesses make people feel small or powerless.

Example

Adler himself was weak and sick as a child. That pushed him to become a strong thinker and successful doctor.

Tip

Weakness can become the **starting point of strength**.

5. Striving for Superiority

Answer

Because of inferiority, people develop **striving for superiority**, meaning they try to overcome weakness and feel strong, capable, and important.

Key terms

- *Superiority* – Not dominating others, but becoming better and more competent.

Explanation

We feel small → we try to become big.

We feel weak → we try to become strong.

Example

A poor child studies hard to become a successful professional.

Tip

Superiority = growth, not arrogance.

6. Compensation and Overcompensation

A. Compensation

Answer

Compensation means trying to overcome a weakness by improving yourself.

Explanation

You see a problem in yourself and work to fix it.

Example

Bad at math → you practice more.

Tip

Healthy and positive response.

B. Overcompensation

Answer

Overcompensation means trying too hard to cover your weakness, often in an extreme way.

Explanation

You go too far to hide your inferiority.

Example

A short man becomes extremely aggressive to prove he is "strong."

Tip

Overcompensation can look confident but comes from insecurity.

7. Inferiority Feelings and Inferiority Complex

Answer

Everyone has **feelings of inferiority**, but when they become overwhelming, they form an **inferiority complex**.

Key terms

- *Inferiority complex* – A deep, constant feeling of being useless, weak, or not good enough.

Explanation

Normal: "I am not good at this yet."

Complex: "I am nothing. I can never succeed."

Example

A student avoids class because he believes he is stupid.

Tip

Inferiority feelings are normal. Inferiority complex is unhealthy.

8. Aggression and Social Interest

Answer

Adler believed people develop **aggression** (energy to move forward) and **social interest** (care for others).

Key terms

- *Aggression* – Energy and drive to act.
- *Social interest* – Concern for society and others.

Explanation

Healthy person = strong + caring.

Example

A leader who is confident and also helps others.

Tip

Real strength includes kindness.

9. Mental Disorders as Lifestyle

Answer

Adler believed mental illness shows a person's **style of life**, not just brain problems.

Explanation

Your way of thinking, coping, and relating can cause problems.

Example

A person avoids life challenges → anxiety grows.

Tip

Therapy helps change lifestyle patterns.

10. Adlerian Therapy

Adlerian therapy focuses on understanding the person's whole life.

Main Methods

1. **Good relationship** – Therapist and patient trust each other.
2. **Direct conversation** – Open, honest talking.
3. **Dream interpretation** – Dreams show life problems symbolically.
4. **Childhood memories** – Early memories reveal lifestyle.
5. **Heroes and role models** – Show goals and values.
6. **Body language** – Sitting, walking, talking shows personality.

Example

A person who remembers being ignored as a child may now avoid relationships.

Tip

Adlerian therapy looks at *why* you live the way you do.

Final Summary in Simple Words

Adler believed:

- Humans are whole beings.
 - We are driven to improve ourselves.
 - We feel weak → we try to grow.
 - How we handle weakness shapes our personality.
 - Therapy helps us understand and change our lifestyle.
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Summary of Adler's Key Ideas

Concept	Meaning	Example
Individual Psychology	Study people as wholes	Focus on lifestyle, not traits
Lifestyle	Way of living and solving problems	Problem-solving style, social approach
Striving for Perfection	Main human motivation	Student trying to reach full potential
Organic Inferiority	Biological/physical weaknesses	Weak eyes → improves intellect
Compensation	Overcoming weakness	Weak leg → exercises or develops skills
Overcompensation	Exaggerating strengths	Weak in sports → becomes obsessive gym-goer
Inferiority Complex	Overwhelmed by weaknesses	Social anxiety, avoidance
Striving for Superiority	Drive to improve	Excelling academically or socially
Social Interest	Healthy, community-focused motivation	Helping others, volunteering
Style of Life	Individual pattern of coping	Aggressive, cooperative, creative

1. Who was Alfred Adler?

Answer:

Alfred Adler (1870–1937) was an Austrian medical doctor and psychologist. He initially trained as an ophthalmologist (eye doctor), later switched to general medicine, and finally focused on psychiatry (the study and treatment of mental disorders). Adler briefly worked with Sigmund Freud but disagreed with his emphasis on sexual drives and unconscious conflicts. He founded his own approach called **Individual Psychology** and focused on understanding people as complete individuals.

Explanation:

Adler's journey shows how he moved from physical medicine to mental health. He respected Freud but felt people were more motivated by goals and growth rather than unconscious sexual urges. He emphasized understanding the person's **whole life** instead of just internal conflicts.

Example:

Freud might say a child's fear comes from unconscious sexual tension; Adler would say it comes from feelings of inferiority and the drive to overcome them.

Tips:

Remember Adler as the psychologist who focused on **purpose, growth, and overcoming weaknesses**, not hidden sexual conflicts.

2. What is Individual Psychology?

Answer:

Individual Psychology is Adler's theory that a person should be understood as a **whole**, not just as separate traits or parts. He focused on a person's **lifestyle** (the way they live, handle problems, and relate to others) instead of traditional personality traits.

Explanation:

"Individual" literally means "undivided." Adler rejected breaking personality into components like Freud did. He believed understanding the **pattern of behavior and choices** in everyday life gives a more complete picture of a person.

Example:

Two students fail a test. One says, "I'll try harder next time" (positive lifestyle), while the other says, "I'm hopeless" (negative lifestyle). Both have different lifestyles.

Tips:

Think of lifestyle as a **personal life blueprint** showing how a person approaches challenges, relationships, and goals.

3. What is the main motivating force according to Adler?

Answer:

The main motivating force is **striving for perfection**, which is the innate desire to improve oneself, reach full potential, and achieve personal goals. This is similar to the idea of **self-actualization** in other psychology theories.

Explanation:

Adler believed people are driven by future goals rather than past events. This drive motivates learning, growth, and overcoming difficulties.

Example:

A shy student joins public speaking clubs to gain confidence and improve social skills.

Tips:

Remember: *striving for perfection = human growth and personal improvement, not being perfect.*

4. What is organic inferiority?

Answer:

Organic inferiority refers to **physical or biological weaknesses** in the body or organs that may affect a person's functioning. These weaknesses often trigger a drive to overcome them.

Explanation:

Everyone has strengths and weaknesses. Adler observed that recognizing and compensating for these weaknesses influences personality development.

Example:

A child with weak eyesight works harder in sports or academics to compensate for the physical limitation.

Tips:

Weaknesses are normal; how a person responds to them matters.

5. What is striving for superiority?

Answer:

Striving for superiority is the effort to **overcome personal weaknesses** and become more capable, competent, or valuable. It is a natural response to feelings of inferiority and is a positive force when balanced.

Explanation:

When we notice our weaknesses, we naturally try to improve. Striving for superiority is not about dominating others, but about personal growth and achieving goals.

Example:

A student who struggles with writing takes extra classes to become a strong writer.

Tips:

Think of it as *personal improvement*—turning weaknesses into strengths.

6. What are compensation and overcompensation?

Answer:

- **Compensation:** Efforts to overcome a weakness or limitation.
- **Overcompensation:** Extreme efforts to hide or cover up a weakness, sometimes in unhealthy ways.

Explanation:

Compensation is normal and positive. Overcompensation occurs when a person tries too hard, often leading to aggression, arrogance, or unrealistic behavior.

Example:

- Compensation: Someone bad at singing practices and improves gradually.
- Overcompensation: Someone bad at singing becomes overly critical of others' performances to feel superior.

Tips:

Healthy coping = compensation; excessive coping = overcompensation.

7. What is an inferiority complex?

Answer:

An **inferiority complex** occurs when feelings of inferiority become overwhelming, causing self-doubt, avoidance, and low self-esteem. It is different from normal inferiority feelings, which are temporary and manageable.

Explanation:

Everyone feels inferior sometimes. If these feelings dominate, they can restrict personal growth and harm relationships.

Example:

A student avoids applying for scholarships because they believe they are not smart enough.

Tips:

Inferiority feelings are normal; the complex develops when they take over daily life.

8. What is social interest and its role?

Answer:

Social interest is a person's **concern for others and society**, which balances personal ambition. It helps people achieve goals while contributing positively to the community.

Explanation:

Adler believed healthy personality involves both striving for personal success and caring for others. Lack of social interest can lead to selfish or aggressive behavior.

Example:

A student volunteers to tutor peers while improving their own grades.

Tips:

Striving for success alone is not enough—Adler emphasizes **growth + connection with society**.

9. How does Adlerian therapy work?

Answer:

Adlerian therapy focuses on **understanding a person's lifestyle and underlying motivations**. Techniques include:

1. Developing a good relationship with the patient.
2. Direct conversation about life challenges.
3. Dream interpretation.
4. Analysis of childhood memories.
5. Exploring likes/dislikes of heroes and role models.
6. Observing body language and behavior.

Explanation:

Therapy is holistic. It looks at **patterns, goals, and personal history** to understand and change unhealthy behaviors.

Example:

A patient may realize fear of failure comes from childhood experiences of criticism and learns new ways to cope.

Tips:

Adlerian therapy = understanding the person's **whole life story**, not just symptoms.

1. Discuss the life and contributions of Alfred Adler.

Answer:

A. Life of Alfred Adler

- Born on February 7, 1870, in Vienna, Austria; died May 28, 1937.
- Initially trained as a medical doctor; received his degree from the University of Vienna in 1895.
- Began as an ophthalmologist, switched to general medicine, and then focused on psychiatry.
- Joined Freud's discussion group in 1907 and became president of the Viennese Analytic Society.
- Developed a critical stance toward Freud's ideas, particularly Freud's sexual focus.
- In 1911, resigned with 9 members to form the **Society for Free Psychoanalysis**, later renamed **Society for Individual Psychology**.

B. Contributions to Psychology

- Founded **Individual Psychology**.
- Introduced the concept of **lifestyle** as a holistic way to understand personality.
- Proposed **striving for perfection** as the primary motivating force behind human behavior.
- Studied **organic inferiority** and how people compensate or overcompensate for weaknesses.
- Developed ideas about **inferiority complex**, **social interest**, and **mental health as lifestyle**.
- Pioneered **holistic therapy** including childhood memories, dreams, and social relationships.

C. Key Concepts Introduced

Concept	Meaning	Example
Individual Psychology	Study of the person as a whole, not parts	Considering lifestyle instead of only personality traits

Concept	Meaning	Example
Lifestyle	The unique way a person handles problems and relationships	Two students failing a test respond differently
Striving for Perfection	Desire to fulfill one's potential	A shy student joins a debate club
Organic Inferiority	Physical or biological weakness	Weak eyesight or short stature
Inferiority Complex	Overwhelming feelings of inferiority	Avoiding tasks due to "I can't do it" mindset
Compensation	Efforts to overcome weaknesses	Practicing hard to improve in a weak subject
Overcompensation	Excessive efforts to hide weaknesses	Acting aggressively to prove superiority
Social Interest	Concern for others and society	Tutoring peers while studying yourself

Plain-English Explanation:

Adler was a doctor who moved from physical medicine to psychology. Unlike Freud, he believed **humans are motivated by goals and growth**, not hidden sexual conflicts. His big idea was that you must understand the **whole person**, not just internal traits. Weaknesses in body or life push people to grow, and personality develops from **how a person handles these challenges**.

Example:

Adler himself was a sickly child, but that motivated him to become strong in mind and career.

Tip:

Remember Adler as the psychologist who focuses on **strength, growth, and lifestyle**, not past conflicts.

2. Explain the concept of Individual Psychology and its main principles.

Answer:

A. Definition:

Individual Psychology is the study of a person as a **complete, integrated whole**, focusing on **goals, lifestyle, and social relationships** rather than separate mental components.

B. Main Principles:

1. **Holism (Seeing the whole person):** Personality must be studied as a unified entity.
2. **Lifestyle:** The unique way a person solves problems, approaches life, and interacts socially.
3. **Striving for Perfection:** All behavior is motivated by the desire to improve and fulfill potential.
4. **Inferiority and Compensation:** Weaknesses drive people to improve (compensation) or, if extreme, to overcompensate.
5. **Social Interest:** True mental health includes care for others and contribution to society.

C. Key Relationships:

Concept	Related Idea	Example
Lifestyle	How a person lives and solves problems	Two students fail: one perseveres, the other quits
Inferiority	Feeling weak or inadequate	Short stature in childhood
Compensation	Effort to overcome weakness	Practicing sports despite physical limitation
Overcompensation	Extreme effort to hide weakness	Overly aggressive to mask insecurity
Social Interest	Concern for community	Volunteering or helping peers

Plain-English Explanation:

Instead of dissecting personality into pieces, Adler said we should **look at the whole life pattern**. How you handle challenges, relationships, and goals shows your **lifestyle**. Weaknesses motivate growth, and social interest balances personal ambition with caring for others.

Example:

A student weak at math practices hard (compensation) but also tutors friends (social interest).

Tip:

Lifestyle = your **signature way of living and solving problems.**

3. What are organic inferiority and striving for superiority? How do they influence personality development?

Answer:

A. Organic Inferiority:

- Definition: Weakness in body or organs affecting functioning.
- Example: Poor eyesight, weak heart, or short stature.

B. Striving for Superiority:

- Definition: Effort to **overcome weaknesses** and become stronger, capable, and competent.
- Example: A short child trains in running to excel in sports.

C. Role in Personality Development:

1. **Compensation:** Healthy response; effort to overcome weakness.
2. **Overcompensation:** Extreme response; may become aggressive or arrogant.
3. **Inferiority Complex:** Failure to cope; feeling inadequate and defeated.

D. Flowchart of Influence:

Organic Inferiority → Feelings of Weakness →
1) Compensation → Personal Growth
2) Overcompensation → Excessive or Aggressive Behavior
3) Inferiority Complex → Anxiety, Avoidance, Low Self-Esteem

Plain-English Explanation:

Weaknesses are normal, but how we respond shapes personality. Some grow stronger, some overdo it, some feel defeated. The **striving for superiority** is the natural drive to overcome weakness.

Example:

A student who struggles with writing may:

- Work harder (compensation)
- Become overly critical of others' writing (overcompensation)
- Give up entirely (inferiority complex)

Tip:

Remember: personality = **response to challenges**, not just traits you are born with.

4. Explain inferiority complex and social interest.

Answer:**A. Inferiority Complex:**

- Definition: Feeling of being **overwhelmed by inadequacy**, leading to self-doubt and avoidance.
- Causes: Organic inferiority, criticism, failure, lack of support.
- Example: Avoiding public speaking because of fear of embarrassment.

B. Social Interest:

- Definition: Caring about others and society; essential for mental health.
- Importance: Balances personal ambition with contribution.
- Example: Helping classmates while also studying for exams.

C. Relationship Between the Two:

Inferiority Complex	Social Interest	Result
Dominant feelings of inadequacy	Low concern for others	Isolation, depression
Managed feelings of inferiority	Strong social interest	Growth, healthy relationships

Plain-English Explanation:

Everyone feels inadequate sometimes, but it's **unhealthy if it dominates life**. Social interest ensures growth is balanced with care for others.

Example:

Someone weak in math can either avoid class (complex) or tutor others while improving (healthy).

Tip:

Inferiority complex = “stuck in weakness”; Social interest = “use strength to help self and others.”

5. Describe Adlerian therapy and its techniques.

Answer:

A. Goal of Therapy:

- To understand the **whole person** and help overcome weaknesses by analyzing lifestyle, goals, and relationships.

B. Main Techniques:

1. **Good relationship:** Build trust between therapist and patient.
2. **Direct conversation:** Honest discussion of problems.
3. **Dream interpretation:** Reveal hidden motivations and conflicts.
4. **Childhood memories:** Understand how early experiences shape lifestyle.
5. **Heroes and role models:** Reveal values and aspirations.
6. **Body language and behavior:** Observe posture, walking, and gestures for insight.

C. Key Points:

- Disorders often have roots in **childhood experiences** or environment.
 - Therapy focuses on **changing lifestyle patterns**, not only treating symptoms.
 - Encourages development of **social interest and healthy striving for superiority**.
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Plain-English Explanation:

Adlerian therapy is **holistic**: it looks at the person's history, goals, lifestyle, and social context. It is not just about symptoms but **why the person lives the way they do**.

Example:

A patient may realize anxiety comes from childhood criticism. Therapy focuses on **building confidence, coping skills, and caring for others**.

Tip:

Think of Adlerian therapy as a **map of your life** to understand how you became who you are and how to improve.

A. True/False MCQs

1. Adler believed that personality should be understood by studying the unconscious sexual conflicts of an individual.

- **Answer:** False

- **Explanation:** Adler disagreed with Freud's sexual focus. He emphasized **lifestyle, goals, and social interest** rather than unconscious sexual conflicts.

1. According to Adler, everyone experiences feelings of inferiority at some point in life.

- **Answer:** True

- **Explanation:** Inferiority feelings are normal. Only when they dominate and prevent growth do they become an **inferiority complex**.

1. Overcompensation occurs when a person makes moderate efforts to overcome a weakness.

- **Answer:** False

- **Explanation:** Overcompensation is **excessive efforts**, often to hide weakness, not moderate attempts.

1. Adlerian therapy focuses solely on the patient's symptoms and ignores their lifestyle.

- **Answer:** False

- **Explanation:** Adlerian therapy is **holistic**, analyzing lifestyle, childhood, goals, and social context.

B. Conceptual MCQs

1. Which of the following best describes Adler's concept of "lifestyle"?

- A. The set of unconscious impulses influencing behavior

- B. The unique way an individual approaches problems and relationships

- C. The inherited traits that determine personality
- D. The conflicts between id, ego, and superego

- **Answer:** B

- **Explanation:** Lifestyle in Adler's theory is **how a person solves problems, handles relationships, and approaches life goals.**

1. Striving for perfection, according to Adler, is:

- A. Trying to become flawless and perfect in all things
- B. The innate drive to fulfill one's potential and improve life
- C. Avoiding weaknesses and flaws
- D. The desire to dominate others

- **Answer:** B

- **Explanation:** Adler's "striving for perfection" is **personal growth and achieving potential**, not literal perfection or domination.

1. Organic inferiority refers to:

- A. Psychological weakness due to trauma
- B. Weakness in physical or biological organs
- C. Lack of motivation to succeed
- D. Inherited social traits

- **Answer:** B

- **Explanation:** Organic inferiority is **physical or biological weakness** that may trigger compensation.

1. Which statement about social interest is correct?

- A. It is only important for people with strong personalities.
- B. It refers to concern for others and society, essential for mental health.
- C. It is unrelated to personality development.
- D. It is a synonym for inferiority complex.

- **Answer:** B

- **Explanation:** Social interest = **care for others**, a central concept for healthy personality in Adler's theory.

C. Situational / Application MCQs

1. A student who struggles with public speaking practices daily and volunteers to help classmates improve their skills demonstrates:

- A. Inferiority complex
- B. Compensation and social interest
- C. Overcompensation and aggression
- D. Organic inferiority without growth

- **Answer:** B

- **Explanation:** The student **compensates for weakness** (public speaking) and shows **social interest** by helping others.

1. Ali is extremely aggressive and critical of peers because he is short and feels insecure about his height. Which Adlerian concept best explains his behavior?

- A. Social interest
- B. Inferiority complex
- C. Overcompensation
- D. Striving for perfection

- **Answer:** C

- **Explanation:** Ali is attempting **overcompensation**, using aggression to mask feelings of weakness.

1. Sara avoids challenging tasks and believes she can never succeed due to repeated failures. According to Adler, this is an example of:

- A. Healthy compensation
- B. Inferiority complex
- C. Social interest
- D. Lifestyle development

- **Answer:** B

- **Explanation:** Sara's **overwhelming feelings of inferiority** lead to avoidance, which defines an **inferiority complex**.

1. During Adlerian therapy, a patient is asked to describe their favorite heroes and role models. What is the purpose of this technique?

- A. To analyze unconscious sexual desires
- B. To reveal childhood traumas
- C. To identify values, goals, and lifestyle patterns
- D. To increase feelings of inferiority

- **Answer:** C

- **Explanation:** Heroes and role models help **understand goals, aspirations, and lifestyle patterns**, central in Adlerian analysis.

1. A teacher notices that one student is very weak physically but compensates by becoming an excellent artist, while another student gives up entirely. According to Adler, the first student shows _____ while the second shows _____.

- A. Overcompensation; compensation
- B. Compensation; inferiority complex
- C. Social interest; overcompensation
- D. Inferiority complex; compensation

- **Answer:** B

- **Explanation:** The first student **compensates** for physical weakness; the second develops an **inferiority complex** due to being overwhelmed.

1. Which of the following statements is most consistent with Adler's perspective on human motivation?

- A. People are primarily motivated by unconscious sexual drives.
- B. People are primarily motivated by the desire to overcome weakness and achieve personal goals.
- C. People's behavior is entirely determined by biology.
- D. People cannot change their personalities once childhood is over.

- **Answer:** B

- **Explanation:** Adler emphasized **goal-directed growth and striving for superiority**, not unconscious sexual drives or determinism.

D. Tricky / Concept Integration MCQs

1. Which combination correctly matches Adlerian concepts with examples?

Concept	Example
Inferiority complex	Avoiding public speaking because of fear of failure
Overcompensation	Acting aggressive to cover insecurity
Striving for perfection	Practicing daily to master piano skills
Social interest	Volunteering at a community center

- A. All correct
- B. Inferiority complex and overcompensation are swapped
- C. Social interest is incorrect
- D. Striving for perfection is incorrect

- **Answer:** A

- **Explanation:** Each example correctly matches its **Adlerian concept**.

1. During therapy, a psychologist focuses on the patient's childhood memories, dreams, body language, and relationships. The main purpose is:

- A. To determine IQ level
- B. To identify lifestyle, goals, and sources of inferiority
- C. To analyze only unconscious desires
- D. To enforce strict behavioral rules

- **Answer:** B

- **Explanation:** Adlerian therapy examines **lifestyle patterns, inferiority feelings, and social interest** holistically.

Cheat Sheet: Alfred Adler & Individual Psychology (Lesson 33)

1. Key Terms & Definitions

Term	Definition	Keyword	Small Example	Memory Hook / Mnemonic
Individual Psychology	Study of a person as a whole, focusing on lifestyle and goals	Holistic	Two students fail: one perseveres, one quits	<i>"Individual = undivided"</i>
Lifestyle	Unique way a person approaches life, problems, and relationships	Life pattern	Student responds positively/negatively to failure	<i>"Lifestyle = Life way"</i>
Striving for Perfection	Drive to reach full potential and improve oneself	Growth	Shy student joins debate club	Mnemonic: "SP = Self Progress"
Organic Inferiority	Physical or biological weakness in body/organs	Weakness	Weak eyesight, short stature	<i>"Organs weak → start to seek"</i>
Striving for Superiority	Effort to overcome weakness and grow	Improvement	Child practices sports to compensate for small size	Mnemonic: "SS = Strength Surge"
Compensation	Healthy effort to overcome weakness	Balance	Practicing math to improve poor grades	<i>"Compensate = Cover & Improve"</i>
Overcompensation	Excessive effort to hide weakness	Excess	Acting aggressive to mask short stature	Mnemonic: "Over = Overkill"
Inferiority Complex	Feeling overwhelmed by inadequacy	Self-doubt	Avoiding tasks due to "I can't" mindset	<i>"Complex = Crippling weakness"</i>
Social Interest	Concern for others and society; essential for mental health	Care	Tutoring classmates	Mnemonic: "SI = Serve Individuals"

Term	Definition	Keyword	Small Example	Memory Hook / Mnemonic
Adlerian Therapy	Holistic therapy analyzing lifestyle, goals, childhood, dreams, and relationships	Therapy	Patient explores childhood memory & dreams	<i>"Holistic = Whole person"</i>

2. Key Concepts & Mini Examples

Concept	Explanation	Example
Holism	Look at whole personality, not parts	Lifestyle > Traits
Motivation	Driven by striving for perfection	Student joins debate to improve
Compensation	Healthy overcoming of weakness	Poor eyesight → studies harder
Overcompensation	Extreme effort to hide weakness	Short → acts aggressive
Inferiority Complex	Overwhelming sense of inadequacy	Avoids exams
Lifestyle	Pattern of coping & relationships	Responses to success/failure
Social Interest	Growth balanced with care for others	Tutoring peers while improving yourself

3. Quick Mnemonics / Memory Hooks

- **"SPI-COS"** → Adlerian Key Concepts
 - **S**triving for **P**erfection
 - **I**nfertility feelings
 - **C**ompensation
 - **O**vercompensation
 - **S**ocial Interest
- **"Weak Organs → Grow Strong"** → Organic Inferiority → Striving for Superiority

- **"Lifestyle = Life way"** → Helps remember it's about daily patterns and solving life problems.
- **"Inferiority Complex = Crippling Complex"** → Overwhelmed by weakness.
- **Therapy Techniques Mnemonic: "CDHD-B"**
 - **C**onversation (direct talk)
 - **D**ream analysis
 - **H**istory / childhood memories
 - **D**esires / heroes and role models
 - **B**ody language observation

4. Flow of Concepts (Visual)

Organic Inferiority (weakness)



Feelings of Inferiority



| | |

Compensation Overcompensation Inferiority Complex
(growth) (excessive) (avoidance)



Lifestyle formation



Striving for Perfection + Social Interest → Healthy personality

5. Adler vs Freud (Quick Comparison Table)

Feature	Freud	Adler
Focus	Unconscious sexual drives	Goals, growth, overcoming inferiority
Motivation	Instincts & conflicts	Striving for perfection
Personality	Id, ego, superego	Lifestyle & holistic view
Therapy	Psychoanalysis	Adlerian (holistic, goal-oriented)

Feature	Freud	Adler
Social View	Minimal	Social interest central